

Nothing of the old land-marks remained, except the ravine itself. The little bushes had become tall trees so that one could not see any of the beautiful old hills. We dodged under the fence to get some wild plums - little Mary Hupert and I - but it was too much of a real jungle to attempt to follow the ravine. So we dodged back and followed the pasture fence up over what we used to call the "burch-burned-hill," - a picturesque prominence sixty-five years ago with a beautiful bunch of white burch trees like a beard on its nose and about a half dozen enormous boulders to kinda protect them. Mary about 13, soon left me behind climbing - with my heavy habit over my other clothes and was smiling at my puffing when I reached the top. The one-time bolders have been taken over by the burch-family that has converted them into as many little mounds.

We then made for the open field which had not grown much or changed since 1881. Down over the hill we went past the auto the others had left near the sight where you were born to the spring - just a little puddle now. I felt that I had climbed enough; so waited at the spring till their voices reached up from away down in the woody ravine. Then I whistled on my thumbs and they answered. Seeing the jungle-like proposition I would have been up against had I attempted to come down that short quarter of a mile, they had just finished three Patres and Aves in honor of the Little Flower that their Rev. associate might some how appear.

We climbed back to the auto where I had left Mary and then took a last view of the old building-sight. All was left was the caved-in cellar, with an acorn that we did not have to look for. Its sprout upwards was thirty feet.....

Six of us - Mary's brother and the driver - started back over the field. Having dropped the children off at the house we started via River Falls for Saint Paul - stopping in the former to visit my God-mother, Mrs. Cath. Manion Lowe, 83. Needless to say she was pleased that we called. It was her rough and ready, big-hearted father-in-law who moved us from the River-bank home when I was about three years old. It seemed to me even then that he was an old man though he probably was not more than in his fifties.

How wonderful is memory and all the gifts of God that He blesses us with! Who would ever have dreamed it possible sixty years ago that we'd be able some day to get to St. Paul just as an evening drive? Thanks be to God for all His blessings and mercies. Thanks also to our Blessed Mother Mary, next to Jesus for having given Him to us.